PRACTICAL GUIDE

Get the Best Output from Fable 5

7 golden rules for prompting Claude · Website design · Content agents · SEO agents · Build any agent you want

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#1

FABLE 5 · GOLDEN PRINCIPLES

Assign a Role — and Lock XML Structure

The first sentence defines the model's identity. The more precise the role, the more consistent the tone, depth, and quality of output.

- Open with: "You are a senior [role] with [X] years of experience…"
- Separate sections with XML tags: <context>, <task>, <rules>, <output_format>
- Claude models are trained for this structure — use it every time

#2

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Give Examples — and Lock the Output Format

One good example outperforms ten lines of explanation. The model copies style and format directly from your sample.

- Attach 1–2 examples of your ideal output inside the prompt
- Specify the exact format: "3-column table", "JSON with these keys", "article with H2 and H3"
- Vague instructions produce inconsistent, taste-dependent results

#3

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Let It Think — and Give Positive Commands

For complex tasks, prompt the model to reason before it answers. And always frame your rules as what TO do, not what to avoid.

- Add "think step-by-step before answering" for analytical tasks
- In Claude Code, "think" and "ultrathink" increase reasoning depth
- Instead of "don't be long" → write "respond in max 3 paragraphs"

#4

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Break Big Tasks Into Verifiable Steps

Instead of "build a complete site," go step by step: structure first, then design, then content. Review each stage before moving forward.

- Never dump an entire project into one message
- Confirm outputs at each milestone before continuing
- The Smart Lazy Law: build one great prompt, save it, only change the blanks

#5

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Build Any Agent in 6 Blocks

Every agent — from customer support to SEO writing — is made from the same architecture. Master this template once and deploy it anywhere.

- Identity · Knowledge · Process · Boundaries · Format · Examples
- Test with 5 real inputs; add rules or examples wherever it fails
- Great prompts aren't written — they're grown through iteration

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